

**Tentative Rulings**  
June 10, 2026  
Department S-17  
Judge Joseph Ortiz

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Tentative Rulings for Department S-17 are posted on the court's website (<https://www.sb-court.org/divisions/civil/civil-tentative-rulings>) at 3:00 p.m. or at 7:00 p.m. the court day before the hearing. If no tentative ruling is posted at 3:00 p.m., please check again after 7:00 p.m.

Unless you wish to submit on the tentative ruling, you must appear for the hearing either in person, CourtCall (888-882-6878 or [www.courtcall.com](http://www.courtcall.com)), or by ZOOM. Failure to appear is deemed a waiver of oral argument. If you wish to submit to the tentative, please call the Judicial Assistant at (909) 708-8715 in advance of the hearing. If all parties submit on a tentative ruling, it will become final. The tentative ruling may seek input on particular issues and direct appearance. If so directed, attendance at the hearing is mandatory. The party prevailing on a motion or other hearing shall serve written notice of the court's ruling unless all parties waive notice of the ruling.

**ATTENTION:** Since January 9, 2023, the court no longer provides an official Court Reporter to transcribe proceedings. Parties who wish to have a transcript must retain their own private reporter and must submit a "Stipulation and Order to Use Certified Shorthand Reporter." Please contact the Department if you need this form. Parties who do not retain their own reporter have waived the right to one.

**UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED, THE PREVAILING PARTY IS TO GIVE NOTICE OF THE RULING.**

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13. *Guy v. Loma Linda Univ. Med. Cntr., et al*, Case No. CIVSB2607407

Def. Loma Linda's Demurrer

6/10/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

The Court would **CONTINUE** the matter so that movant may satisfy the meet-and-confer requirements.

Prior to a demurrer, a party is required meet and confer in person or by telephone or by video conference with the party who filed the pleading for purposes of "determining whether an agreement can be reached that would resolve the objections to be raised in the demurrer." (Code Civ. Proc., § 430.41(a).)

Here, the supporting declaration does not confirm compliance with the meet-and-confer requirements. (See Cannon Decl.) Rather, the declaration simply unilaterally asserts that the attorney "met and conferred." (Cannon Decl., ¶12.) No statements were provided setting forth the actions that constitute the attempt. Thus, the Court cannot confirm whether the process was in person, by telephone, or by video, as required by Code.

Thus, the Court would continue the matter to allow a supplemental declaration expressly showing compliance. Defendant will file a supplemental declaration at least ten court days before the next hearing.

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14. *Castro's Cleaning Servs. Co., Inc., v Ryan Peacock, Inc., et al*, Case No. CIVSB2505507

Motion to Compel Responses from Ryan Peacock, Inc. to Special Interrogatories, Set One  
6/10/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

The Court would **GRANT** Plaintiff's unopposed motion to compel responses from Defendant Ryan Peacock to Special Interrogatories, Set One (SROG1). The Court would further **GRANT** sanctions in the amount of \$1,141.00. Both responses and sanctions are due within thirty days.

Relevant here, Plaintiff served SROG1 on Defendant Ryan Peacock on September 29, 2025. (Schiller Decl., ¶12.) An extension on time to respond was requested and granted, and, pursuant to the extension, responses were due no later than January 6, 2026. (Schiller Decl., ¶13.) No responses have been provided; thus, the motion became necessary.

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16. *Portfolio Recovery Associates, LLC, v. Coley*, Case No. CIVSB2214509  
Defendant's Motion to Set Aside Judgment  
6/10/26, 9:00 a.m., Dept. S-17

### ***Tentative Ruling***

The Court would **DENY**.

### ***Case Summary***

This is a collections case. Plaintiff alleges maintained a credit account founded in writing with Plaintiff, with periodic billing, that required payment thereon. However, Plaintiff stopped paying on the account on February 10, 2020, leaving an open balance that is the subject of this suit. On July 12, 2022, Plaintiff filed suit for (1) account stated and (2) open book account.

Relevant here, on September 9, 2022, Plaintiff filed a proof of service (POS) stating that Defendant was served at his home address. (See Compl., ¶11 & Exh. A [billing showing address].) The POS indicates personal service on a "brown-haired white female".

Following service, Plaintiff took Defendant's default, and a default judgment was entered on April 20, 2023. Now, approximately three years later, Defendant filed this instant motion seeking to vacate the judgment. Defendant alleges service was improper.

### ***Analysis***

To set aside a judgment pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 473.5(a), the motion for relief must be served and filed within a reasonable time, but in no event may exceed the earlier of: (1) two years after entry of a default judgment; or (2) 180 days after service of written notice that default or default judgment entered. Further, the motion must be accompanied by a copy of the answer or other proposed responsive pleading. (Code Civ. Proc., 473.5(b).) Here, the instant motion was filed on April 1, 2026, approximately three years beyond the default judgment. Thus, the motion appears untimely. Further, it is procedurally defective since it was not accompanied by a copy of any proposed responsive pleading.

Even in the alternative, however, the motion appears at first blush to be lacking:

As a starting point, the filed proof of service shows service by a registered process server. The return of a registered process server is entitled to an evidentiary presumption of the facts stated in the return. (Evid. Code, § 647; *Palmer Properties Inv., LLC, v Yadegar* (2011) 194 Cal.App.4th 1419, 1427.) Once the presumption is created, the burden shifts to the party contesting service to rebut the presumption through competent, contradictory evidence. (*M. Lowenstein & Sons, Inc. v. Superior Court* (1978) 80 Cal.App.3d 762, 770; also *Los Angeles v. Morgan* (1951) 105 Cal.App.2d 726, 731.).

Here, perhaps tellingly, neither the original declaration nor the supplemental declaration contest *actual*<sup>1</sup> notice of the lawsuit. Rather, the declaration indicates that he is not a female and that the POS indicates service on a female. (See Coley Supp. Decl., ¶14.) Defendant offers no evidence, other than his own unsupported statements, to substantiate his claims that the address was improper or that the POS description of “female” was anything other than a scrivener’s error. For instance, a dated lease agreement or mailed bills from the at-issue time period would have substantiated whether the claimed address was incorrect. Thus, even if the motion were timely (which it is not), Defendant has not currently offered sufficient competent, contradictory evidence to rebut the presumption of proper service.

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<sup>1</sup> The Supplemental Declaration argues that Defendant was not “personally handed” any court documents. (Coley Supp. Decl., ¶13.) Similarly, the original Declaration does not say he was not served but, rather, that he was not “properly” served. (E.g., Coley Decl., ¶16.) Thus, the declarations appear to sidestep the issues of whether substitute service occurred or whether actual notice was none-the-less provided.